

AUSPICIA ADVERSA

COHORTIS XIV LEGIO — OFFICIUM HARUSPICIS

The following signs have been observed and formally recorded in the seven days preceding this report. Each is witnessed by at least two men. I append my interpretation as required by my office.

- I All camp dogs died at midnight on the third day. No visible cause. No disease, no poison. The bodies were cold before dawn.
- II Sacrificial sheep presented black livers at both morning observations. The second animal was sourced from separate stock. The result was identical.
- III Ravens observed flying reversed pattern over the *principia* on two separate occasions. Not one bird. A group. In formation.
- IV Springs in the northeast sector run discoloured. Iron contamination suspected. The source has not been located despite three inspections.
- V Night sentries on the east wall report shadows without bodies. Six independent reports across five nights. No two men knew the others had seen it.
- VI Legionaries on north patrol report distant war-horns after midnight. No enemy force has been located. The horn was heard on three separate nights.

The augury is not favorable. I advise against major operations and all descent into subterranean areas until a full expiation is performed and the omens are re-examined. This report has been filed. What is done with it is the Legate's decision, not mine.

GAIUS PATERCULUS, HARUSPEX

IN THE CONSULSHIP OF RUFUS AND QUINTILLUS

ANNO DCCCCXXVIII AUC